predominant form of engagement in the production process. In the industrial economy, the employer was essentially the controller of capital who engaged labour as the employee. In today's world, the intellectual property (IP) creator or owner is the principal 'employer' of skilled labour. But, in many situations, the employee is not labour, but a contractor or vendor. Laws and regulations need to be amended to reflect this change.

This can be done by bringing a single Workmen Management Act by replacing the Wage Code and Industrial Relations Law. The minimum age of labour should be revised from fifteen to twenty—neither is there a requirement of so much labour that children below the age of twenty should work nor is fourteen years adequate enough a period for children to acquire requisite education and skills for modern jobs/work. Until the age of twenty, everyone should be expected to study, play and learn skills, paid for by family and wherever needed by the state.

This law should provide for compulsory single-point national registration of every person as a working age person/labour upon completion of twenty years of age. This system should have all the basic details about the skills and experience possessed by every such person. This portal should enable matching of skills needed by establishments and offered by the labour, wherever needed. The labour should file changes in its employment status, including statistically important information. The government should also reform the complex compensation structure embodied in the Wage Code in myriad forms—wages, overtime, bonus, gratuity and other job-related benefits— by adopting a simple cost-to-company/cost-to-employer compensation system. By abolishing the occupation-wise minimum wage system, the cost-to-company/cost-to-employer compensation should be left to be agreed between the employer and employee by the Workmen Management law. The government should only declare a national minimum wage and create enforcement machinery